SHADOWRUN BUILDER

Player & GM guide · Shadowrun Sixth World

Open it in any browser, on phone, tablet or computer: **awesomeesel.github.io/shadowrun-builder**

Shadowrun Builder helps you make a Sixth World runner by the book, keeps the sheet up to date as the character grows, and does the bookkeeping at the table: dice pools, damage, Edge, ammo, spells and spirits. The GM gets a screen of their own for campaigns, encounters and a quick rules reference, and can follow the players' sheets live.

Build

A step-by-step wizard that checks the creation rules as you go.

Play

Tap a pool to roll. Damage, Edge, ammo and wound modifiers are tracked for you.

Share

Scan the GM's QR code and your sheet shows up on their screen.

Run

GM tools: turn order, enemies from your books, statuses, rules lookup.

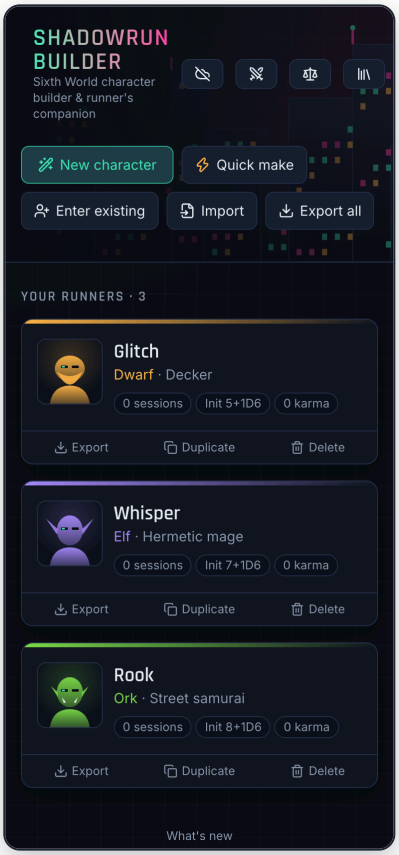
FOUR WAYS TO GET A RUNNER

New character	The wizard. Eight steps: concept, priorities, attributes, skills, qualities, gear, contacts and review. Each step has tips and a checklist, and the counters at the top show what you have left to spend.
Quick make	A finished, legal runner in one click. Pick a role and metatype. Great for a one-shot or an NPC. With rulebooks in the Library it also picks gear, qualities and spells.
Enter existing	Type in a character you already have (on paper or elsewhere) without the creation rules getting in the way.
Import	Load a file exported from Shadowrun Builder, or a Commlink (commlink.rocks) export. You get a report of what came across.

WHERE YOUR DATA LIVES

Everything is saved in your browser as you go; there is no account and no save button. That also means clearing the browser's site data deletes it, so connect a backup:

- **Google Drive** (top of the start page) keeps your characters in a "Shadowrun Builder" folder in *your own* Drive and syncs them between your devices. GMs: campaigns and encounters are backed up there too.
- **Export** on a character downloads it as a file; **Export all** saves every character at once.

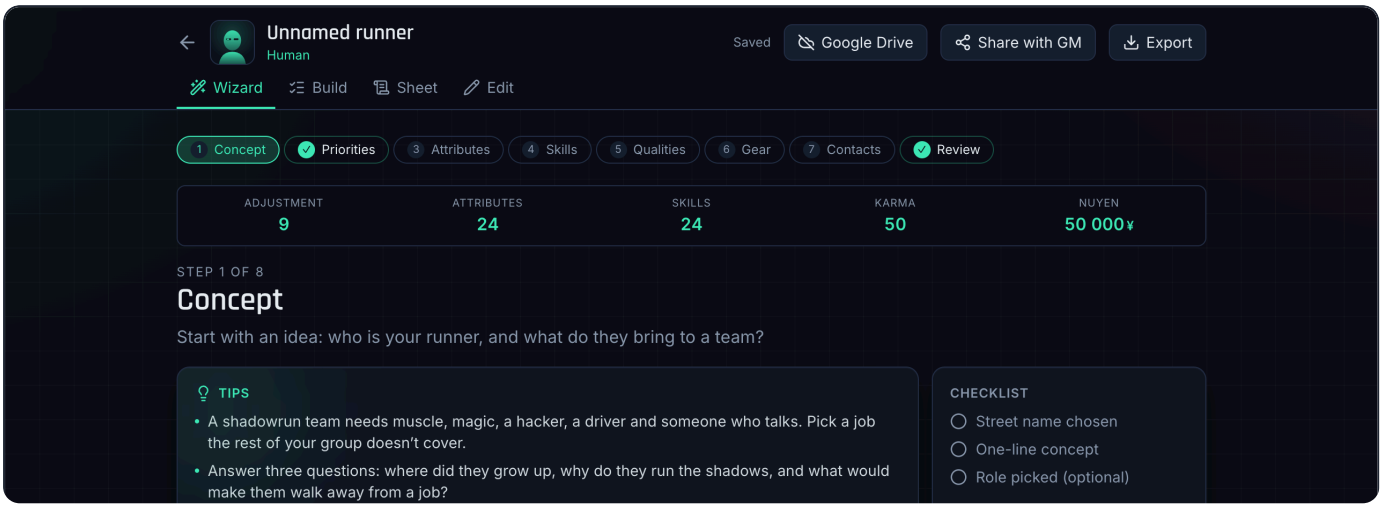


The start page on a phone: your runners, and the buttons for making new ones. GM, Rules and Library sit at the top.

> **TIP** On a phone, use the browser's *Add to Home Screen* to get an icon that opens the app full screen.

2 Building and growing your runner

The wizard walks you through character creation; the other tabs keep the character right afterwards.



The wizard. Steps along the top (a tick means done), what you have left to spend below them, then tips and a checklist for the current step.

THE WIZARD, STEP BY STEP

- **Concept**: name and idea. Picking a role (street samurai, decker, face…) makes the wizard suggest priorities, attributes and skills for it. You can ignore every suggestion.
- **Priorities**: choose A–E for metatype, attributes, skills, magic and resources.
- **Attributes**: each attribute shows your metatype's range. The highest value is the limit, not a target.
- **Skills, Qualities, Gear, Contacts**: pick from the lists. If your rulebooks are in the Library, items come with their prices and page numbers.
- **Review**: lists anything that breaks the creation rules. When it's clean, finish the character to start playing.

Prefer one long page? The **Build** tab shows every choice at once.

AFTER CREATION

Sheet	Everything worked out: dice pools, Defense Rating, damage tracks, Matrix numbers. **Print play sheet** gives you one page for pen-and-paper play.
Play	The table view: see page 3.
Karma	Spend karma between runs at the book's prices: attributes, skills, specializations, qualities, spells, initiation and submersion. Every purchase is logged.
Edit	Change anything by hand. The menu at the top jumps to a section.

ADD YOUR RULEBOOKS

In the **Library**, add the Shadowrun 6 PDFs you own. They stay on your device, and if you like you can also keep a copy in your own Google Drive. With books added:

- page references like **CRB 245** open the right page;
- you can search the text of every book;
- gear, qualities and spells can be picked from the books, with prices and stats filled in;
- GMs can add grunts and critters straight from the stat blocks.

> **NOTE** The app itself contains no book text. It reads the PDFs you add, in your own browser, and only copies them to your Drive if you ask it to.

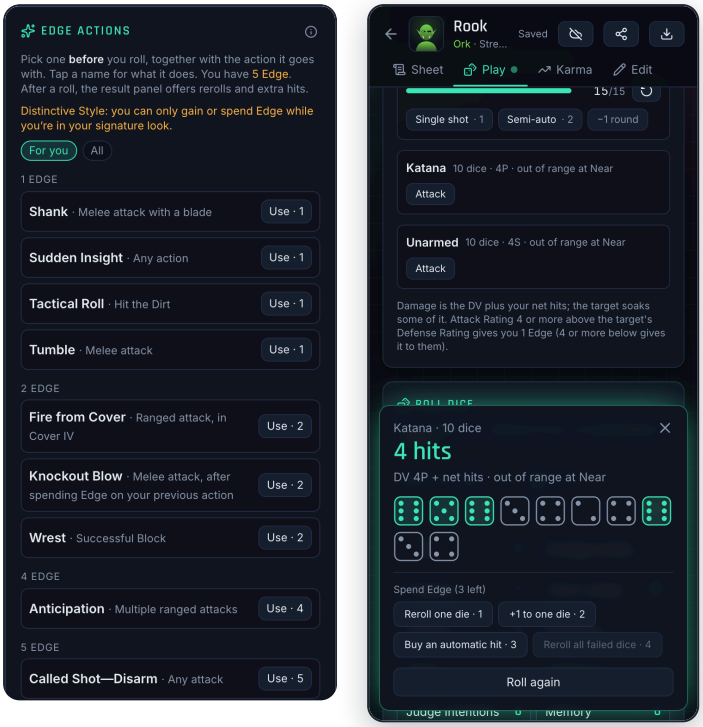
GOOD TO KNOW

- Attribute names are written in full everywhere (Body, Agility…), and pools show how they're made, e.g. *Defense (Reaction + Intuition)*.
- Augmentations, grades (alpha, used…), bone lacing and similar bonuses change the numbers for you.
- A cyberdeck and a cyberjack work together; programs on the deck count toward its slots.
- When a new version is out, a banner offers **Reload**, and **What's new** lists the changes.

> **TIP** Use **Duplicate** on the start page before a big experiment, such as trying a different build.

3 At the table: the Play tab

Your character sheet, turned into a play screen. Open it on your phone when the game starts.



Left: Edge actions that fit your runner, chosen before you roll. Right: an attack rolled; tap a die to spend Edge on it.

NEW TO THE GAME? A short guide sits at the top of every session until you hide it, and every ⓘ (next to pools, stats and damage tracks) says what it is and when to roll it, with the page in the book.

REAL DICE? Use the app as a smart sheet: it shows the right pool with wounds, sustained spells and range counted. Just mark damage and Edge.

A SESSION, START TO FINISH

1. **Ready check**: before the run, the Play tab looks over injuries, ammo, armor, programs, sustained spells, spirits and rent, with one-tap fixes like *Heal all* and *Reload all*.
2. **Start session**: Edge refills and you get the play screen. Your rolls are logged for the session summary.
3. **Status**: tap boxes to mark damage, or use **Take damage...**: it rolls your resistance and fills the boxes. Wound modifiers come off every pool by themselves. Statuses (Burning, Cover...) are listed with what they do.
4. **Edge** (at most 7): *before* a roll, pick an Edge action such as Shank or Called Shot—Vitals and tap **Use**; *after* it, reroll a die, add 1, buy a hit or reroll misses.
5. **Combat**: roll initiative to start a fight. The tracker counts rounds and the Major and Minor actions you have left.
6. **Attack**: pick the range and firing mode and tap **Attack**. Ammo counts down; reload with one tap. The result shows the DV and how the Attack Rating compares.
7. **End session**: write down karma, nuyen, Heat and Reputation. It all goes into the session log and your money and karma history. You can heal between runs here too.

MAGIC, MATRIX AND MORE

- **Spells**: cast, then resist drain. Sustained spells are listed, with their −2 dice each counted for you.
- **Spirits and sprites**: summon or compile, track services, tasks and damage; banish or decompile someone else's.
- **Drones and vehicles**: their own damage tracks and pilot rolls.
- **Matrix**: your persona's numbers, programs, Matrix damage and Overwatch Score.
- **Roll dice**: every skill, with specializations as their own pool (↳ Blades), plus a +/− modifier. Your qualities are listed with what they do.

PEN AND PAPER? On the Sheet tab, **Print play sheet** makes a one-page sheet with boxes for damage, Edge, ammo and Overwatch, and lines for spells, spirits, money and notes.

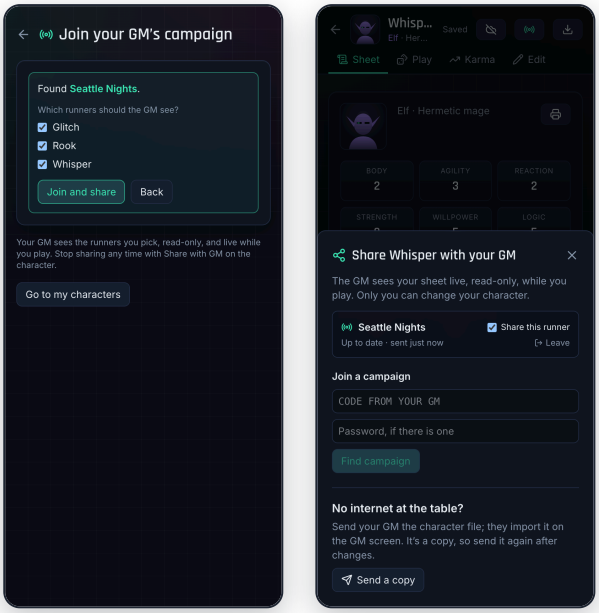
4 Sharing with your GM

Your GM can follow your runner live: sheet, damage, Edge and ammo. They can look; only you can change your character.

PLAYERS: JOINING A CAMPAIGN

1. The GM shows a **QR code** (or gives you a **code** like *K7QM-4XRA-P2DN* and maybe a **password**).
2. Scan it with your phone camera. The app opens and finds the campaign; check that the name is right.
3. Tick the runners the GM should see and tap **Join and share**. That's it.

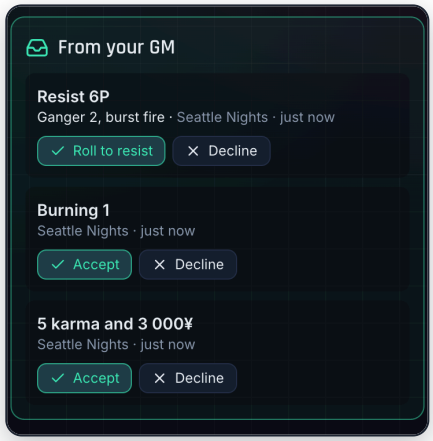
No QR code? Open the character, tap **Share with GM** (the share icon at the top), type the code and password, and tap **Find campaign**.



Left: what the QR code opens. Right: *Share with GM* on a character.

WHILE YOU PLAY

- Changes reach the GM a few seconds after you make them, as long as you're online. Offline changes are sent when you're back.
- The share icon at the top of a shared character turns green. Tap it to see "Up to date", to stop sharing that runner, or to leave the campaign.
- If the GM closes the campaign, you'll see it there and can remove it.
- **From your GM**: damage, a status, Edge or a reward shows at the top of your character. Nothing changes until you **Accept**; **Decline** if it's wrong.



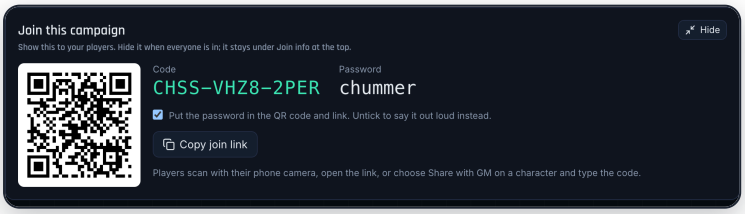
Damage, a status and a reward from the GM, waiting for the player.

NO INTERNET AT THE TABLE?

In the same dialog, **Send a copy** sends your character file through the phone's share menu (chat, mail, AirDrop…). The GM imports it on their campaign page. It's a snapshot, so send it again after changes.

> **PRIVACY** Sheets are encrypted on your device with the campaign code and password before they leave it, so the server in between can't read them. Only people with the code and password can see the shared runners.

GM: INVITING THE PLAYERS



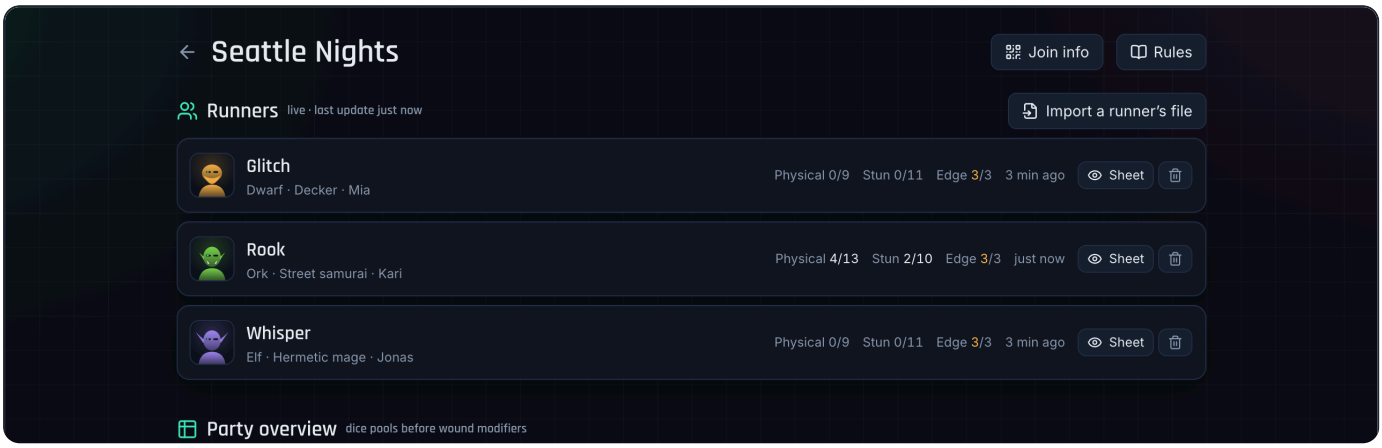
The join panel at the top of a new campaign (an example: this code doesn't work).

1. On the **GM** screen, tap **New campaign**. Give it a name and, if you like, a password.
2. The campaign page opens with the QR code, code and password at the top. Show it to the table.
3. When everyone is in, tap **Hide**. It moves to **Join info** at the top, which opens it full-size for latecomers.

> **TIP** Untick "Put the password in the QR code" and say the password out loud. Then a photo of the screen alone isn't enough to join.

5 For the GM: campaigns

The GM button on the start page opens your screen. Each campaign keeps your group together: its runners, cast, encounters, run log and notes.



A campaign page: the runners shared with it (live), the party overview, encounters, and further down the run log and notes.

RUNNERS

Each shared runner shows their damage, Edge and when they last changed. Tap **Sheet** for their full sheet, read-only. Use the bin icon to remove a runner; the player can share again.

Import a runner's file adds a runner a player sent with Send a copy.

PARTY OVERVIEW

The numbers you check or roll in secret, for the whole group: Initiative, Defense Rating, Defense, Soak, Perception, Surprise, Composure, Judge Intentions, Memory, Edge, Heat, Reputation, Wounds, plus magic type, astral sight and cyberdecks. Hover a column header to see how it's made.

CAST

Your recurring people: the fixer, the Johnson, the gang boss with a grudge. **Add someone** with who they are, ally, neutral or enemy, and notes. Give the ones who might fight a stat block from your books or a few quick numbers, and they're one tap away in any encounter.

RUN LOG AND NOTES

Log a run after each game night: date, title, karma and nuyen paid to each runner, who played and what happened. Totals per runner add up at the top. Notes hold plot threads, NPCs and loose ends. Players never see either.

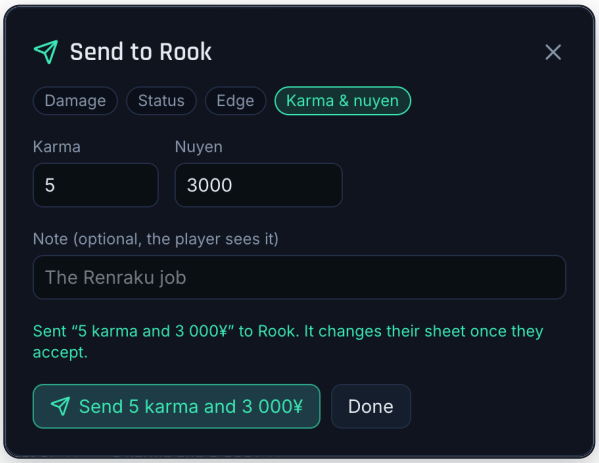
BACKUPS AND OTHER DEVICES

Connect **Google Drive** and everything on the GM screen is backed up to a "GM" folder in your Drive: campaigns with their codes and passwords, cast, encounters, notes and run log. Connect the same Drive on your laptop and tablet and it follows you. An orange banner warns you while nothing is backed up.

> **HEADS-UP** Only the device that made a campaign can close it, remove runners or send to players. On your other devices you can see and run everything else.

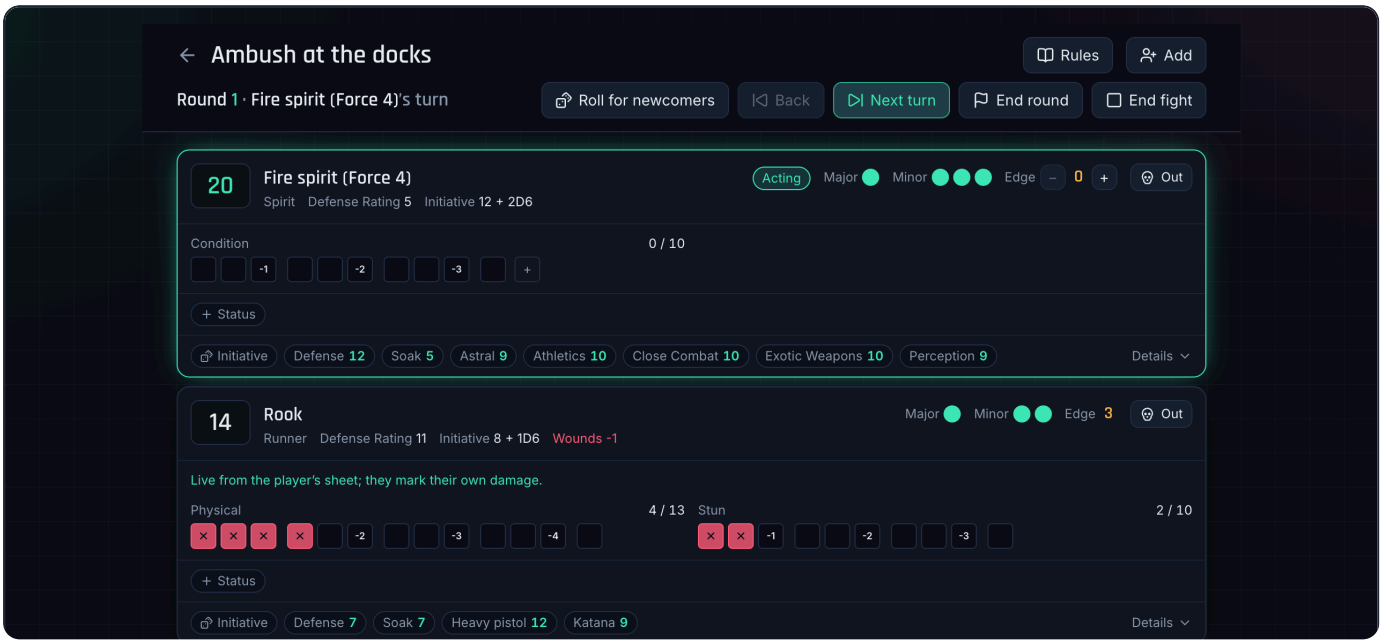
SENDING TO PLAYERS

- **Send…** on a runner: damage (to resist, or straight onto the boxes), a status, Edge, or karma and nuyen. It lands on the player's sheet once they accept.
- Anything not yet accepted shows as *Waiting for the player*; the × takes it back.
- **Log a run** can send the run's karma and nuyen to everyone who played.
- Under Runners, choose what you may send. Untick both and the Send buttons disappear.



6 For the GM: encounters and rules

Set up fights before the session; at the table, the action screen keeps the turn order, actions, damage and statuses for everyone.



An encounter in round 1. The fire spirit is acting; Rook's damage comes live from the player's phone.

SETTING UP

New encounter on the campaign page, then **Add**:

- **From the books**: grunts, critters and contacts from the stat blocks in your Library. Add several at once to make a **grunt group**: they share one initiative roll and an Edge pool equal to their Professional Rating.
- **Cast**: your campaign's recurring people, under their own name and with their notes. **Spirit**: type and Force. **Runner**: shared runners (live damage and Edge) or just a name. **Quick enemy**: a few numbers for anything else.

RUNNING THE FIGHT

1. **Roll NPC initiative**. Players roll their own and tell you; type it on their card.
2. **Start round 1**, then **Next turn**. Ties are broken by Edge, then Reaction, then Intuition.
3. At the end of each round, actions refill, timed statuses count down, and a banner reminds you who resists Burning, Corrosive or Poison damage.
4. Pressed Next too soon? **Back** undoes it, damage stays. **End fight** when it's over.

ON EACH CARD

- Major and Minor action pips: tap to use, tap again to give back.
- Damage boxes with the wound modifier marked (every 2 boxes for grunts, 3 for others), and **Out** for anyone down or fled.
- **+ Status**: Burning 3, Cover II, Dazed for 2 rounds... Dazed, Chilled and Zapped also lower initiative.
- Dice chips roll with wounds already counted, and Edge boosts after the roll.
- Shared runners show the player's own damage, Edge and statuses (marked *player*, counted for initiative); **Send...** sends them damage, a status or Edge to accept.

RULES REFERENCE

Rules has short summaries with page numbers: rounds, actions, attacking, Edge, damage and healing, magic and Matrix, statuses. Searching also looks through every book in your Library.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Prepare encounters at home; one tap during the game.
- Keep the Rules page open in a second tab.
- Use the party overview for secret Perception and Surprise rolls.
- Log the run before everyone leaves, while it's fresh.

> **TROUBLE?** *"No campaign with that code and password"*: check both with the GM; codes have 12 letters and digits and never use O, 0, I, 1 or L. · *The GM can't see me*: open Share with GM and look for "Up to date". · *Drive says Reconnect*: the Google sign-in lasts an hour; tap to continue.